



INSIGHTSMASTERY ACADEMY
STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Install Power BI Desktop, DAX Studio & Tabular Editor 2

Official download sources • Step-by-step installation
External Tools integration • Verification checklist

For Windows 10 / 11 (64-bit recommended)
Use this SOP for learner machines and lab setups

Document version 1.0 | InsightsMastery Academy
www.insightsmastry.in



Table of Contents

1. Purpose & Scope
2. Prerequisites & System Requirements
3. Install Power BI Desktop
4. Install DAX Studio
5. Install Tabular Editor 2
6. Register as External Tools in Power BI Desktop
7. Verification Checklist
8. Troubleshooting
9. Official Download Links (Quick Reference)



1. Purpose & Scope

This SOP describes the standard process to install and configure the three core tools used in InsightsMastery Power BI programs:

- **Power BI Desktop** — authoring reports and semantic models
- **DAX Studio** — writing, analyzing, and performance-tuning DAX queries
- **Tabular Editor 2** — advanced model editing, scripting, and Best Practice Analyzer (free edition)

Follow the steps in order. After installation, External Tools integration lets you launch DAX Studio and Tabular Editor directly from the Power BI Desktop ribbon.



2. Prerequisites & System Requirements

Operating system

Windows 10 or Windows 11 (64-bit strongly recommended). 32-bit Power BI Desktop is no longer supported for new installs.

Hardware (minimum practical)

- 4 GB RAM (8 GB or more recommended for real models)
- At least 2 GB free disk space for installers and programs
- Internet connection for download and Microsoft Store (if used)

Accounts & rights

- Local Administrator rights may be required (especially for “All Users” installs).
- Microsoft account helpful for Microsoft Store install of Power BI Desktop.
- No paid license is required for Power BI Desktop (free), DAX Studio (free), or Tabular Editor 2 (free/open source).

■ Recommended order

1) Power BI Desktop → 2) DAX Studio → 3) Tabular Editor 2 → 4) Confirm External Tools appear in Power BI Desktop.



3. Install Power BI Desktop

Prefer the **Microsoft Store** method for automatic updates. Use the direct download when Store is blocked by policy.

Option A — Microsoft Store (recommended)

Step 1: Open the Store page

Open a browser and go to: <https://aka.ms/pbidesktopstore>
Or in Power BI service (app.powerbi.com) click the Download icon (top right) → Power BI Desktop.
Or search "Power BI Desktop" in the Microsoft Store app.

Step 2: Install

Click **Get** or **Install**.
Sign in with a Microsoft account if prompted.
Wait for download and installation to finish.
Launch Power BI Desktop from the Start menu.

Option B — Direct download (EXE)

Step 1: Download

Go to: <https://aka.ms/pbidesktop> (or Microsoft Download Center for Power BI Desktop).
Select the **64-bit** installer (PBIDesktopSetup_x64.exe).
Save the file.

Step 2: Run the installer

Double-click the downloaded .exe.
Accept the license agreement → Next.
Choose installation folder (default is fine) → Next.
Optionally create a desktop shortcut → Install.
When finished, check "Launch Power BI Desktop" → Finish.

■ 64-bit only for new installs

Microsoft no longer supports new 32-bit installations of Power BI Desktop. Always choose the x64 package.

Official reference: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/fundamentals/desktop-get-the-desktop>



4. Install DAX Studio

DAX Studio is the standard tool for writing and analyzing DAX. The installer can register it as an External Tool in Power BI Desktop.

Step 1: Download

Go to the official site: <https://daxstudio.org/>
Download the latest **setup.exe** installer (e.g. DaxStudio_x_x_x_setup.exe).
Avoid the portable ZIP unless you specifically need a portable install.

Step 2: Run the installer

Double-click the setup.exe.
If SmartScreen appears, click More info → Run anyway (the installer is signed).
Choose **All Users** (recommended — requires admin) or Current User.
Accept the license → Next.
Keep default components (including Power BI External Tools integration) → Install.
Finish the wizard.

Step 3: First launch check

Open DAX Studio from the Start menu.
You should see a connection dialog. You can cancel for now.
Close DAX Studio; we will launch it from Power BI later.

■ Install type recommendation

Use "All Users" when possible. It installs under Program Files, enables Excel add-in options, and correctly registers External Tools for all users on the machine.

Official docs: <https://daxstudio.org/docs/installation/>



5. Install Tabular Editor 2

Tabular Editor 2 is the free, open-source edition (MIT license). It is ideal for measure management, display folders, Best Practice Analyzer, and C# scripting. (Tabular Editor 3 is commercial and not covered in this SOP.)

Step 1: Download

Go to the GitHub releases page: <https://github.com/TabularEditor/TabularEditor/releases/latest>
Under Assets, download **TabularEditor.2.x.x.Installer.msi** (Windows installer).
Optionally note the portable .zip if you need a no-install version.

Step 2: Run the MSI installer

Double-click the .msi file.
Accept the license agreement → Next.
Choose installation folder (default is fine) → Next.
Click Install (admin rights may be required).
Finish the wizard.

Step 3: Confirm installation

Open Tabular Editor 2 from the Start menu.
You should see the main window with File → Open, etc.
Close it for now.

■ Tabular Editor 2 vs 3

This SOP installs Tabular Editor 2 (free). Tabular Editor 3 is a separate commercial product with a different installer and license. Do not mix the two when following course materials that specify TE2.

Docs: <https://docs.tabulareditor.com/getting-started/Getting-Started-te2.html>



6. Register as External Tools in Power BI Desktop

When installed with the recommended options, both tools usually register automatically. Verify and fix if needed.

Verify External Tools

Step 1: Open Power BI Desktop

Launch Power BI Desktop (empty file is fine).
Look at the ribbon for an **External Tools** tab.
You should see icons for DAX Studio and Tabular Editor.

Step 2: If the tab or icons are missing

Close Power BI Desktop.
Re-run the DAX Studio installer and ensure the External Tools / Power BI integration option is selected.
For Tabular Editor 2: the installer normally writes a .pbtool.json file under:

```
%ProgramData%\Microsoft\Windows\Start Menu\Programs\...\External Tools  
or  
%CommonProgramFiles%\Microsoft Shared\Power BI Desktop\External Tools
```

After fixing, restart Power BI Desktop. With a model open, click the tool icon on the External Tools tab — it should connect to the current model.

■ How External Tools work

Power BI Desktop looks for .pbtool.json registration files in the External Tools folder. The installers place these files for you. Launching from the ribbon passes the current model connection to the tool.



7. Verification Checklist

Complete this checklist after installation:

- Power BI Desktop opens from Start menu without error
- Help → About shows a recent version (monthly updates)
- DAX Studio opens from Start menu
- Tabular Editor 2 opens from Start menu
- Power BI Desktop shows an External Tools ribbon tab
- DAX Studio icon appears on External Tools tab
- Tabular Editor icon appears on External Tools tab
- Open any .pbix → External Tools → DAX Studio connects to the model
- Open any .pbix → External Tools → Tabular Editor loads the model metadata

Once all items are checked, the machine is ready for InsightsMastery Power BI labs and courses.



8. Troubleshooting

SmartScreen blocks the installer

Click More info → Run anyway. Official DAX Studio and Tabular Editor installers are signed.

External Tools tab missing

Confirm install was “All Users” where possible. Restart Power BI Desktop. Re-run DAX Studio installer with External Tools option.

DAX Studio cannot connect to Power BI

Open a .pbix first, then launch DAX Studio from External Tools (not from Start menu alone).

Tabular Editor 2 does not see the model

Launch it from the External Tools ribbon while the .pbix is open. Or use File → Open → From DB and connect to the local Power BI instance.

Microsoft Store not available

Use the direct EXE download for Power BI Desktop from aka.ms/pbidesktop.

Admin rights required

Use Current User install for DAX Studio if All Users is blocked. Tabular Editor MSI may still need elevation.



9. Official Download Links (Quick Reference)

Tool	Primary download	Notes
Power BI Desktop	aka.ms/pbidesktopstore or aka.ms/pbidesktop	Store preferred; 64-bit EXE alternative
DAX Studio	https://daxstudio.org/	Use setup.exe (not portable) for External Tools
Tabular Editor 2	github.com/TabularEditor/TabularEditor/releases/latest	Download the .msi installer

Table 1 — Official sources (always prefer these over third-party mirrors)



InsightsMastery Academy

Install SOP — Power BI Desktop • DAX Studio • Tabular Editor 2

Install once. Verify External Tools. Start building.

www.insightsmastry.in